SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

26 July 2022 · Shift 1

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. In the delicacy and elaborateness / of its ornament, it is the / more splendid church in Italy.

(A) of its ornament it is the
(B) No error
(C) In the delicacy and elaborateness
(D) more splendid church in Italy

Q.2

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. The fashion industry is one "of the largest contributors" to global warming.

(A) of the larger contributor
(B) off the largely contributor
(C) of largest contributors
(D) No improvement required

Q.3

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. A large chunk of lemon crop grown in the country goes _____ to factories.

(A) director
(B) directing
(C) directed
(D) directly

Q.4

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Neither Priya nor Rashmi "is planning a" trip.

(A) is plan a
(B) No improvement required
(C) are planning a
(D) will planning an

Q.5

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. If broadly beneficial immigration is to be sustained, destination countries must acknowledge and _____ the real risks that it raises.

(A) address
(B) speak
(C) perform
(D) disregard

Q.6

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A place for storing grain

(A) Treasury
(B) Apiary
(C) Aviary
(D) Granary

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Demote

(A) Break
(B) Elevate
(C) Disregard
(D) Sack

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Astute

(A) Shrewd
(B) Dull
(C) Impolite
(D) Crude

Q.9

Parts of the given sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. If your kids sleep well, they are likely to behave better.

(A) No error
(B) to behave better
(C) they are likely
(D) If your kids sleep well

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The man was _____ enough to thank her for all the hard work.

(A) horrid
(B) repellent
(C) gracious
(D) attractive

Q.11

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Forthright

(A) Motivated
(B) Upfront
(C) Devious
(D) Outspoken

Q.12

Select the correctly spelt word.

(A) Yseterday
(B) Yesterday
(C) Ystrday
(D) Yestarday

Q.13

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Castle in the air

(A) Acquire something honestly
(B) Unrealistic plan
(C) Very expensive
(D) Polluted air

Q.14

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. The last straw

(A) The last ray of hope in an unfortunate situation
(B) The last financial resource
(C) The only option left after a series of unsuccessful attempts
(D) The final problem in a series of problems that makes the situation intolerable

Q.15

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A group of fish

(A) Troop
(B) Bunch
(C) Litter
(D) School

Q.16

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the underlined word in the given sentence. The ability to relax and “rejuvenate” promotes wellness.

(A) update
(B) replenish
(C) suppress
(D) revive

Q.17

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. Amoeba is a microscopic single-celled “organism found in” pond water.

(A) organisms founding in
(B) No improvement required
(C) organism find in
(D) organisms found with

Q.18

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. The students was given the task of penning down a short write-up.

(A) given the task of penning
(B) The students was
(C) down a short write-up
(D) No error

Q.19

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Tidy

(A) Muddy
(B) Orderly
(C) Petty
(D) Nominal

Q.20

Select the option that corrects the misspelt words in the given sentence. We have to relie on meaningful contont now.

(A) We have to relie on meaningful content now.
(B) We have to rely on meaningful cuntent now.
(C) We have to rely on meaningful contont now.
(D) We have to rely on meaningful content now.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it's your idea, you want to (1) _____ about it all the time. I've had this problem on more than a few occasions now. I know there shouldn't be any shame in (2) _____ your work, but it's such a task to draw the line. In my case, since my work is all things related to social media, this problem gets even (3) _____ convoluted. Long story short, I hate that I (4) _____ have to worry about when it's okay to promote, and when it's (5) _____

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) customise
(B) express
(C) talk
(D) meet

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it's your idea, you want to (1) _____ about it all the time. I've had this problem on more than a few occasions now. I know there shouldn't be any shame in (2) _____ your work, but it's such a task to draw the line. In my case, since my work is all things related to social media, this problem gets even (3) _____ convoluted. Long story short, I hate that I (4) _____ have to worry about when it's okay to promote, and when it's (5) _____

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) leaning
(B) demoting
(C) asking
(D) promoting

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it's your idea, you want to (1) _____ about it all the time. I've had this problem on more than a few occasions now. I know there shouldn't be any shame in (2) _____ your work, but it's such a task to draw the line. In my case, since my work is all things related to social media, this problem gets even (3) _____ convoluted. Long story short, I hate that I (4) _____ have to worry about when it's okay to promote, and when it's (5) _____

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) least
(B) less
(C) more
(D) most

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it's your idea, you want to (1) _____ about it all the time. I've had this problem on more than a few occasions now. I know there shouldn't be any shame in (2) _____ your work, but it's such a task to draw the line. In my case, since my work is all things related to social media, this problem gets even (3) _____ convoluted. Long story short, I hate that I (4) _____ have to worry about when it's okay to promote, and when it's (5) _____

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) occasionally
(B) constantly
(C) rarely
(D) never

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. When it's your idea, you want to (1) _____ about it all the time. I've had this problem on more than a few occasions now. I know there shouldn't be any shame in (2) _____ your work, but it's such a task to draw the line. In my case, since my work is all things related to social media, this problem gets even (3) _____ convoluted. Long story short, I hate that I (4) _____ have to worry about when it's okay to promote, and when it's (5) _____

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) not
(B) none
(C) nothing
(D) no

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. All T are N. II. No M is N. Conclusions: I. All T are M. II. Some T are not M.

(A) Both conclusions I and II follow
(B) Only conclusion I follows
(C) None of the conclusions follow
(D) Only conclusion II follows

Q.3

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: Only a few A1 are P5. Only a few P5 are T8. Conclusions: I. Some A1 are T8. II. All P5 can never be T8.

(A) Only conclusion II follows.
(B) Neither conclusion I nor II follow.
(C) Only conclusion I follows.
(D) Both conclusions I and II follow.

Q.4

Select the option that is related to the fifth term in the same way as the second term is related to the first term and the fourth term is related to the third term. NORMAL : PQTOCN :: REGARD : TGICTF :: TRAVEL : ?

(A) VTCXFN
(B) VTCWGN
(C) VTCXGN
(D) VTCXGM

Q.5

In a certain code language, ‘planes get going’ is coded as ‘pn lm pg’, and ‘hard work get’ is coded as ‘kt rk lm’. ‘hard is you’ is coded as ‘ab rk fg’. What can be the code for ‘work’ in that language?

(A) kn
(B) lm
(C) pg
(D) kt

Q.6

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 8 : 514 :: 3 : 29 :: 7 : ?

(A) 325
(B) 355
(C) 335
(D) 345

Q.7

4 males M1, M2, M3 and M4 are sitting in a row facing towards the west (not necessarily in the same order). 4 females F1, F2, F3 and F4 sitting in a row facing towards the face of these males (not necessarily in the same order). F4 is to the immediate right of F3. One female is sitting between F2 and F3. M3 is diagonally opposite to F2. M2 is second to the right of M4. Which of the following statements can be correct? I. M4 is facing F3. II. M2 is diagonally opposite to F4.

(A) Both I and II
(B) Neither I nor II
(C) Only II
(D) Only I

Q.8

Select the option that is related to the fifth number in the same way as the second number is related to the first number and the fourth number is related to the third number. 14 : 19 :: 25 : 32 :: 103 : ?

(A) 123
(B) 105
(C) 115
(D) 107

Q.9

A, B, C, D, E, and F are standing in a circle talking, facing the centre of the circle. E is standing immediate right to C. D is standing at the third position towards the left of C. A is standing at the second place towards the right of F. Who is standing to the immediate right of D?

(A) B
(B) E
(C) C
(D) A

Q.11

The areas of seven circles C1, C2, C3, C4, C5, C6 and C7 are compared. The area of C2 is greater than C5 and less than C1. The area of C4 is greater than C7 and less than C6. The area of C5 is more than C6. If the area of C7 is the lowest, then which of the following options is correct?

(A) C5 < C4
(B) C3 > C6
(C) C4 > C1
(D) C4 > C2

Q.12

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. POEM : TSIQ :: HINT : ?

(A) LMRX
(B) LMRS
(C) LNRX
(D) LNSX

Q.15

After interchanging the given two signs, what will be the value of the following expression? × and ÷; 35 + 5 ÷ 4 × 2 – 15 = ?

(A) 20
(B) 25
(C) 30
(D) 35

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'WATER' is written as 'XBUFSVZSDQ' and ‘MINOR’ is written as ‘NJOPSLHMNQ’. How will 'ROSES' be written in that language?

(A) EOQTUSPRNM
(B) EOTQUMNRSP
(C) SQPNTRFDTR
(D) SPTFTQNRDR

Q.17

In a certain code language, 'TIN' is coded as '27', and 'GO' is coded as '8'. How will 'PALE' be coded in that language?

(A) 48
(B) 125
(C) 64
(D) 36

Q.18

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 13, 39, 156, 780, ?

(A) 4460
(B) 4580
(C) 4680
(D) 4660

Q.19

In a certain code language, '752' means 'copper is strong', '276' means 'iron is strong' and '365' means 'iron and copper'. Find the code for 'and'.

(A) 6
(B) 3
(C) 2
(D) 5

Q.21
Which two numbers (not digits) should be interchanged to make the following equation correct? 21 × 3 – 10 + 4 ÷ 7 = 5

(A) 21 and 4
(B) 4 and 7
(C) 21 and 3
(D) 3 and 7

Q.22
Select the letter from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. B, H, M, Q, T, ?

(A) V
(B) U
(C) X
(D) W

Q.23
Select the option in which the two numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers in the given number pair. 32 : 85

(A) 42 : 75
(B) 28 : 91
(C) 38 : 77
(D) 24 : 77

Q.25
Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. ABC2 : HIJ9 :: DEF5 : KLM12 :: OPQ16 : ?

(A) UVW23
(B) VWX23
(C) VWX22
(D) UVW22

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1
The reaction between an acid and a base to give a salt and water is called _____.

(A) neutralisation reaction
(B) combination reaction
(C) displacement reaction
(D) decomposition reaction

Q.2
Who among the following was the first Mauryan ruler who tried to spread his message to the people through inscriptions?

(A) Chandragupta
(B) Ashoka
(C) Brihadratha
(D) Bindusara

Q.3
The book 'The Immortals of Meluha' has been written by _____.

(A) Amish Tripathi
(B) Salman Rushdie
(C) Ruskin Bond
(D) Aravind Adiga

Q.4
The Behdienkhlam festival is primarily celebrated in the state of:

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) West Bengal
(C) Meghalaya
(D) Jharkhand

Q.5
India got its central bank in _____.

(A) 1935
(B) 1937
(C) 1940
(D) 1942

Q.6
Which of the following is an example of a fibre crop?

(A) Mango
(B) Hemp
(C) Rubber
(D) Coffee

Q.7
Which country won the maximum number of medals at 2020 Summer Olympic Games (played in 2021)?

(A) United States of America
(B) People's Republic of China
(C) Japan
(D) Great Britain

Q.8
Mehrunnisa married Emperor Jahangir in _____.

(A) 1620
(B) 1602
(C) 1611
(D) 1603

Q.9
Shyam is suffering from Beriberi. This is because he has a deficiency of _____.

(A) Vitamin A
(B) Vitamin K
(C) Vitamin B
(D) Vitamin C

Q.10
Which of the following musical instruments is Ustad Zakir Hussain primarily associated with?

(A) Harmonium
(B) Tabla
(C) Santoor
(D) Flute

Q.11
Which of the following states has the highest sex ratio in India according to Census 2021?

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Kerala
(C) Tamil Nadu
(D) Manipur

Q.12
Which freedom fighter abolished the Zamindari System in Uttar Pradesh and was elected as the Home Minister in 1955?

(A) Lala Hardayal
(B) Govind Ballabh Pant
(C) Gopal Krishna Gokhale
(D) Jyotiba Phule

Q.13
Growth rate of population refers to the:

(A) difference between birth rate and GDP
(B) addition of birth rate and death rate
(C) difference between birth rate and death rate
(D) difference between death rate and GDP

Q.14
The climate of India is described as which of the following types?

(A) Mediterranean
(B) Temperate
(C) Monsoon
(D) Polar

Q.15
Which of the following teams won the Syed Mushtaq Ali (cricket) Trophy, 2021-22?

(A) Uttar Pradesh
(B) Tamil Nadu
(C) Baroda
(D) Karnataka

Q.16
In 1590, the Govind Deva temple of Vrindavan, near Mathura was constructed from _____ sandstone.

(A) yellow
(B) black
(C) white
(D) red

Q.17
Over which state in India does the Mahanadi basin NOT extend?

(A) Chhattisgarh
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Jharkhand
(D) Odisha

Q.18
Which of the following dance forms of India is associated with Rajasthan?

(A) Kalbelia
(B) Kathak
(C) Bharatanatyam
(D) Odissi

Q.19
All of the following are freedom fighters of India who were hanged to death on 23 March 1931 in the Lahore conspiracy case, EXCEPT _____.

(A) Sukhdev
(B) Rajguru
(C) Mahatma Gandhi
(D) Bhagat Singh

Q.20
Sameer wants to contest Lok Sabha elections in India. At what age can he do that?

(A) 18 years
(B) 25 years
(C) 21 years
(D) 30 years

Q.21
Nirmala Sitharaman launched the Tejasvini scheme for the people of _____ in November 2021.

(A) Rajasthan
(B) Punjab
(C) Karnataka
(D) Jammu and Kashmir

Q.22
Athlete's foot is a disease caused by _____.

(A) virus
(B) bacteria
(C) genetic disorder
(D) fungi

Q.23
Which article of the Indian Constitution provides freedom to manage religious affairs?

(A) Article 21
(B) Article 26
(C) Article 20
(D) Article 23

Q.24
Who among the following was crowned Miss Universe, 2021?

(A) Adline Castelino
(B) Andrea Meza
(C) Nadia Ferreira
(D) Harnaaz Sandhu

Q.25
Who among the following is India’s last living Sadhir dancer, honoured with Padma Shri in 2022?

(A) R Muthukannammal
(B) Manjamma Jogati
(C) Rukmini Devi Arundale
(D) Baisali Mohanty

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(B)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(B)**	Q.8 **(A)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(B)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(B)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(D)**	Q.7 **(A)**
Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(D)**
Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.19 **(B)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.23 **(D)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(C)**	Q.9 **(C)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(D)**	Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(B)**	Q.21 **(D)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (D) more splendid church in Italy

Comparing the church with all others in Italy needs the superlative: 'it is the most splendid church in Italy'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) No improvement required

'One of the' is followed by a superlative and a plural noun, so 'one of the largest contributors' is already correct.

Q.3 · Answer (D) directly

The blank describes how the crop goes to factories, so it needs the adverb 'directly'.

Q.4 · Answer (B) No improvement required

With 'neither ... nor' the verb agrees with the nearer subject, here the singular 'Rashmi', so 'is planning a trip' is already correct.

Q.5 · Answer (A) address

To 'address' a risk is to deal with it, which is what countries must do after acknowledging it. 'Disregard' contradicts 'acknowledge', and one does not 'speak' or 'perform' a risk.

Q.6 · Answer (D) Granary

A granary is a storehouse for grain. A treasury holds money or valuables, an apiary is a place where bees are kept and an aviary a large enclosure for birds.

Q.7 · Answer (B) Elevate

To 'demote' is to move someone to a lower rank, so its opposite is 'elevate', to raise to a higher one.

Q.8 · Answer (A) Shrewd

'Astute' means quick to see how to gain an advantage: 'shrewd'. 'Dull' is nearly its opposite.

Q.9 · Answer (A) No error

The conditional is correct as it stands: the present 'sleep' in the 'if' clause with 'they are likely to behave better' in the main clause.

Q.10 · Answer (C) gracious

'Gracious' means courteous and kind, which suits a man who thanks someone for her hard work. 'Horrid' and 'repellent' are unpleasant, and 'attractive' does not fit 'enough to thank'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) Devious

'Forthright' means direct and honest, so its opposite is 'devious', dishonest and scheming. 'Upfront' and 'outspoken' are close in meaning to 'forthright'.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Yesterday

The correct spelling is 'yesterday'.

Q.13 · Answer (B) Unrealistic plan

A 'castle in the air' is a daydream or plan that is unlikely ever to come true.

Q.14 · Answer (D) The final problem in a series of problems that makes the situation intolerable

'The last straw' is the last of a series of troubles, the one that makes a situation impossible to bear (from 'the straw that broke the camel's back').

Q.15 · Answer (D) School

A group of fish swimming together is a 'school'. A troop is a group of monkeys or soldiers and a litter the young born to an animal at one time.

Q.16 · Answer (C) suppress
SSC's key gives 'suppress', to hold down or stifle: not an exact antonym of 'rejuvenate', to make fresh and lively again, but the only option opposite in sense. 'Replenish' and 'revive' are close to 'rejuvenate', and 'update' is unrelated.

Q.17 · Answer (B) No improvement required
'A microscopic single-celled organism' is singular, matching 'Amoeba is', and the past participle 'found' describes where it lives, so the sentence is already correct.

Q.18 · Answer (B) The students was
The plural subject 'the students' takes a plural verb: 'The students were given the task'.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Orderly
'Tidy' means neat and arranged in order: 'orderly'. 'Muddy' is nearly its opposite.

Q.20 · Answer (D) We have to rely on meaningful content now.
The correct spellings are 'rely' and 'content'; only the last option has both.

Q.21 · Answer (C) talk
One 'talks about' an idea; 'express' and 'customise' take no 'about', and 'meet about it' does not fit.

Q.22 · Answer (D) promoting
'Promoting' one's work is what the writer is wary of overdoing, as the last sentence ('when it's okay to promote') shows.

Q.23 · Answer (C) more
'Even' strengthens a comparative, which rules out 'least' and 'most'; the writer's social-media work makes the problem harder, so it gets 'even more convoluted', not less.

Q.24 · Answer (B) constantly
The writer complains of having to worry all the time: 'I hate that I constantly have to worry'.

Q.25 · Answer (A) not
'When it's okay to promote, and when it's not': 'not' negates the repeated phrase 'okay to promote'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (D) Only conclusion II follows
All T are N and no M is N, so no T is M. I is therefore false, and II, some T are not M, follows.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Only conclusion II follows.
'Only a few P5 are T8' means some P5 are T8 and some are not, so all P5 can never be T8: II follows. The A1 that are P5 need not be among the P5 that are T8, so I does not follow.

Q.4 · Answer (C) VTCXGN
Each letter moves 2 places forward: NORMAL → PQTOCN and REGARD → TGICTF. So TRAVEL → VTCXGN.

Q.5 · Answer (D) kt
'Get', common to the first two phrases, is 'lm', and 'hard', common to the last two, is 'rk'. So 'work' is the remaining code of 'hard work get': 'kt'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) 345
The second number is the cube of the first plus 2: $8^3 + 2 = 514$ and $3^3 + 2 = 29$. So $7^3 + 2 = 343 + 2 = 345$.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Both I and II
The males face west, so their right is north, and the females face east, so their right is south. One arrangement that fits every clue, north to south: females F2, F1, F3, F4 and males M2, M1, M4, M3, with M3 and F2 at opposite ends of the two rows. Here M4 faces F3 and M2 is diagonally opposite F4, so both can be correct.

Q.8 · Answer (D) 107
The second number is the first plus the sum of its digits: 14 + 1 + 4 = 19 and 25 + 2 + 5 = 32. So 103 + 1 + 0 + 3 = 107.

Q.9 · Answer (D) A
Going round to the right from C, E comes next and D is third after C (third to C's left is also third to its right among six). A, second to the right of F, then fits only with F between E and D and A just after D, leaving B last: C, E, F, D, A, B. So A is immediately to the right of D.

Q.11 · Answer (B) C3 > C6
SSC's key gives 'C3 > C6'. The statements give C1 > C2 > C5 > C6 > C4 > C7, which rules out the other three options; C3 is known only to be larger than C7, so 'C3 > C6' is the only option that can be true, though the statements do not settle it.

Q.12 · Answer (A) LMRX
Each letter moves 4 places forward: POEM → TSIQ. So HINT → LMRX.

Q.15 · Answer (C) 30
After interchanging × and ÷: 35 + 5 × 4 ÷ 2 − 15 = 35 + 10 − 15 = 30.

Q.16 · Answer (D) SPTFTQNRDR
The code is the word with each letter moved 1 forward, followed by the word with each letter moved 1 back: WATER → XBUFS + VZSDQ. So ROSES → SPTFT + QNRDR: SPTFTQNRDR.

Q.17 · Answer (C) 64
The code is the cube of the number of letters: TIN → $3^3 = 27$ and GO → $2^3 = 8$. So PALE → $4^3 = 64$.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 4680
The terms are multiplied by 3, 4, 5 and 6 in turn: 780 × 6 = 4680.

Q.19 · Answer (B) 3
'Is strong' is common to the first two (7 and 2), 'iron' to the last two (6) and 'copper' to the first and last (5). So 'and' is 3.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 21 and 4
Interchanging 21 and 4: 4 × 3 − 10 + 21 ÷ 7 = 12 − 10 + 3 = 5.

Q.22 · Answer (A) V
The letters move forward 6, 5, 4 and 3 places: B → H → M → Q → T. The next step is 2: T → V.

Q.23 · Answer (D) 24 : 77
The second number is 53 more than the first: 32 + 53 = 85, and likewise 24 + 53 = 77.

Q.25 · Answer (B) VWX23
Each letter moves 7 places forward and the number rises by 7: ABC2 → HIJ9 and DEF5 → KLM12. So OPQ16 → VWX23.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (A) neutralisation reaction
In a neutralisation reaction an acid and a base cancel each other's effect, forming a salt and water.

Q.2 · Answer (B) Ashoka
Ashoka was the first ruler who tried to take his message, his dhamma, to the people through inscriptions on rocks and pillars.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Amish Tripathi
'The Immortals of Meluha' (2010), the first book of the Shiva Trilogy, is by Amish Tripathi.

Q.4 · Answer (C) Meghalaya
Behdienkhlam is the festival of the Pnar (Jaintia) people of Meghalaya, held at Jowai in July after the sowing, to drive away disease and evil.

Q.5 · Answer (A) 1935
The Reserve Bank of India, India's central bank, was set up on 1 April 1935 under the Reserve Bank of India Act, 1934.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Hemp
Hemp is grown for its fibre; cotton, jute, hemp and natural silk are India's major fibre crops. Rubber is a plantation crop grown for its latex, and coffee a beverage crop.

Q.7 · Answer (A) United States of America
The United States won the most medals at the Tokyo 2020 Olympics, 113, including 39 gold, ahead of China.

Q.8 · Answer (C) 1611
Mehrunnisa married Jahangir in 1611 and was given the title Nur Mahal, 'light of the palace'; she later became Nur Jahan, 'light of the world'.

Q.9 · Answer (C) Vitamin B
Beriberi is caused by a lack of thiamine, vitamin B1.

Q.10 · Answer (B) Tabla
Ustad Zakir Hussain, son and disciple of the tabla maestro Ustad Alla Rakha, was a world-renowned tabla player.

Q.11 · Answer (B) Kerala
SSC's key gives Kerala. No census was taken in 2021 (it was postponed), so the question rests on Census 2011, in which Kerala had the highest sex ratio of any state, 1,084 females per 1,000 males.

Q.12 · Answer (B) Govind Ballabh Pant
As Chief Minister of Uttar Pradesh, Govind Ballabh Pant brought in the abolition of the zamindari system in the state; in January 1955 he became Union Home Minister.

Q.13 · Answer (C) difference between birth rate and death rate
The natural growth rate of a population is the birth rate minus the death rate.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Monsoon
India's climate is described as the monsoon type, marked by the seasonal reversal of winds.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Tamil Nadu
Tamil Nadu retained the Syed Mushtaq Ali Trophy in 2021-22, beating Karnataka by four wickets in the final in November 2021.

Q.16 · Answer (D) red
The Govind Deva temple at Vrindavan, built in 1590 under Raja Man Singh of Amber, is of red sandstone.

Q.17 · Answer (B) Uttar Pradesh
The Mahanadi basin lies mainly in Chhattisgarh and Odisha, with smaller parts in Jharkhand, Maharashtra and Madhya Pradesh; it does not reach Uttar Pradesh.

Q.18 · Answer (A) Kalbelia
Kalbelia is the folk dance of the Kalbelia community of Rajasthan. Kathak is a classical dance of north India, chiefly Uttar Pradesh, Bharatanatyam belongs to Tamil Nadu and Odissi to Odisha.

Q.19 · Answer (C) Mahatma Gandhi
Bhagat Singh, Sukhdev and Rajguru were hanged in Lahore Jail on 23 March 1931. Mahatma Gandhi was assassinated in 1948.

Q.20 · Answer (B) 25 years
Under Article 84(b) a member of the Lok Sabha must be at least 25 years old.

Q.21 · Answer (D) Jammu and Kashmir
Nirmala Sitharaman launched the Tejaswini scheme, which gives young women in Jammu and Kashmir financial help to start their own ventures, at the University of Jammu in November 2021.

Q.22 · Answer (D) fungi
Athlete's foot (tinea pedis) is a fungal infection of the skin of the feet.

Q.23 · Answer (B) Article 26
Article 26 gives every religious denomination the freedom to manage its own religious affairs, to set up institutions and to own and administer property.

Q.24 · Answer (D) Harnaaz Sandhu
Harnaaz Sandhu of India was crowned Miss Universe 2021 in December 2021, the third Indian to win after Sushmita Sen and Lara Dutta. Andrea Meza of Mexico was Miss Universe 2020.

Q.25 · Answer (A) R Muthukannammal
R Muthukannammal of Viralimalai, Tamil Nadu, among the last exponents of Sadhir, the temple dance from which Bharatanatyam developed, received the Padma Shri in 2022.

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